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STRAT EDGE SOLUTIONS
Turning **Insight** into Advantage

PROJECT CHARTER- Implementation of the TVET Industry Linkages & Partnerships Framework

Client: Mthashana TVET College
Bidder: Strat Edge Solutions
Duration: 24 Months
Geographic Scope: National | Provincial | International

1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

1.1 Purpose of the Project

The purpose of this project is to design, operationalise, and institutionalise sustainable industry partnerships and linkages for the TVET College through the structured implementation of the Industry Linkages & Partnerships Framework, thereby improving:

- ✓ Graduate employability
- ✓ Industry relevance of programmes
- ✓ Work-integrated learning opportunities
- ✓ Institutional reputation and sustainability

1.2 Strategic Objectives

The project seeks to:

1. Establish formal, value-driven partnerships with industry at national, provincial, and international levels.
2. Embed AI-enabled and digitised partnership systems to improve efficiency, transparency, and scalability.
3. Build long-term relational capital with strategic partners beyond transactional MoUs.
4. Deliver pre-negotiated partnership agreements as part of the tender deliverables.
5. Position the TVET College as a skills, innovation, and productivity partner to industry.

2. PROJECT SCOPE

2.1 In-Scope Activities

- ✓ Development of an enabling Company Profile aligned to the framework
- ✓ Stakeholder and ecosystem mapping
- ✓ Partnership design and segmentation
- ✓ AI-driven partner identification and engagement
- ✓ Relationship-building and trust mobilisation
- ✓ Development of pre-agreements / Letters of Intent (LoIs)
- ✓ Implementation of WIL, apprenticeships, and project-based collaboration
- ✓ International partnership development
- ✓ Governance, monitoring, and sustainability mechanisms

3. METHODOLOGICAL APPROACH

(Highly Differentiated & Bid-Competitive)

The project adopts a five-phase integrated methodology, combining policy alignment, relationship capital, AI & digitisation, and execution discipline.

PHASE 1: FOUNDATION & STRATEGIC ALIGNMENT

3.1 Methodology

Triple Helix + Sector Skills Ecosystem Approach

Activities

- ✓ Review of:
  - ★ DHET priorities
  - ★ SETA Sector Skills Plans
  - ★ Provincial Growth & Development Strategies (PGDS)
- ✓ Sector prioritisation (e.g. manufacturing, ICT, green economy)
- ✓ Alignment workshops with College Executive & Council
- ✓ Establishment of a College–Industry Partnership Steering Committee

Deliverables

- ✓ Strategic Alignment Report
- ✓ Priority Sector Matrix
- ✓ Partnership Governance Structure

PHASE 2: ENABLING COMPANY PROFILE DEVELOPMENT

3.2 Purpose of the Company Profile (Critical Bid Element)

The Company Profile is not a marketing document, but a strategic partnership instrument that enables engagement, trust, and co-investment.

3.3 Company Profile Components (Framework-Aligned)

The profile will:

- ✓ Articulate the College's industry value proposition
- ✓ Present:
  - ★ Skills pipelines
  - ★ Training infrastructure
  - ★ Centres of excellence
  - ★ Innovation and applied research capabilities
- ✓ Demonstrate alignment to:
  - ★ ESG, BBBEE, CSI objectives
  - ★ Productivity and workforce development
- ✓ Include AI-enabled dashboards showing:
  - ★ Graduate output
  - ★ Placement readiness
  - ★ Sector alignment

Deliverables

- ✓ Executive Company Profile (PDF & Digital)
- ✓ Sector-specific profile variants
- ✓ Interactive digital version (QR-enabled)

PHASE 3: AI & DIGITISED PARTNERSHIP DEVELOPMENT

3.4 AI-Enabled Methodology (Key Differentiator)

AI Use Cases

- ✓ **AI partner identification:**
  - ★ Mining industry databases, chambers, LinkedIn, SETAs
- ✓ **Partner segmentation & scoring:**
  - ★ Strategic value, readiness, influence, geographic relevance
- ✓ **Predictive partnership modelling:**
  - ★ Probability of WIL uptake
  - ★ Apprenticeship absorption potential
- ✓ **Digital CRM for partnerships:**
  - ★ Centralised engagement tracking
  - ★ Automated follow-ups
  - ★ Performance dashboards

Tools

- ✓ AI-powered stakeholder mapping tools
- ✓ Digital partnership CRM
- ✓ Online engagement & collaboration portals

Deliverables

- ✓ Digital Partnership Platform
- ✓ AI Partner Intelligence Report
- ✓ Live partnership dashboards

PHASE 4: RELATIONSHIP BUILDING & PRE-AGREEMENTS

3.5 Relationship-Building Methodology

Relationship Capital Development Model

Activities

- ✓ Executive roundtables with strategic employers
- ✓ Sector-focused engagement forums
- ✓ One-on-one partnership design sessions
- ✓ Co-creation workshops (industry + lecturers)
- ✓ Trust-building engagements prior to formal agreements

3.6 Pre-Agreements (Tender Value-Add)

As part of the tender, the bidder will **secure and submit pre-agreements** with selected partners.

Types of Pre-Agreements

- ✓ Letters of Intent (LoIs)
- ✓ Conditional MoUs
- ✓ Expressions of Partnership Support

Areas Covered

- ✓ WIL placements
- ✓ Apprenticeships & learnerships
- ✓ Curriculum co-design
- ✓ Equipment & resource sharing
- ✓ International exchanges (where applicable)

Deliverables

- ✓ Minimum number of signed LoIs (to be specified)
- ✓ Partnership pipeline register
- ✓ Draft MoUs ready for execution

PHASE 5: IMPLEMENTATION, GOVERNANCE & SCALING

3.7 Implementation Streams

- ✓ Work-Integrated Learning (WIL)
- ✓ Apprenticeships & artisan development
- ✓ Project-based industry collaboration
- ✓ International twinning and exchanges

3.8 Governance & Monitoring Framework

Structures

- ✓ Partnership Steering Committee
- ✓ Sector Advisory Panels

- ✓ Quarterly review forums

Monitoring Tools

- ✓ KPI dashboards (placement rates, satisfaction, uptake)
- ✓ AI-driven performance analytics
- ✓ Impact reporting aligned to DHET requirements

Deliverables

- ✓ Governance Framework
- ✓ M&E Reports
- ✓ Annual Partnership Impact Report

4. PROJECT MANAGEMENT APPROACH

4.1 Methodology

- ✓ PMBOK-aligned
- ✓ Agile delivery for partnership development
- ✓ Risk-managed stakeholder engagement

4.2 Risk Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Low industry uptake	Pre-agreements & value proposition
Fragmented engagement	Centralised digital CRM
Sustainability risk	Governance & lifecycle management
Skills mismatch	Continuous sector intelligence

6. EXPECTED OUTCOMES & IMPACT

6.1 Outcomes

- ✓ Formalised industry partnerships
- ✓ Digitised partnership management
- ✓ Improved WIL and apprenticeship uptake
- ✓ International exposure pathways

6.2 Impact

- ✓ Increased graduate employability
- ✓ Reduced recruitment costs for industry
- ✓ Enhanced TVET institutional credibility
- ✓ Sustainable industry–college ecosystems

7. BID DIFFERENTIATORS (WHY THIS BID SHOULD WIN)

- ✓ Framework-aligned, policy-compliant approach
- ✓ AI & digitisation embedded, not cosmetic
- ✓ Relationship capital development (not transactional MoUs)
- ✓ Pre-agreements included before contract award
- ✓ Scalable, sustainable, and governance-driven model

8. THREE-WEEK INTENSIVE WORKPLAN (THE BID PREPERATION)

Purpose of the 3-Week Phase
To rapidly operationalise the Framework, demonstrate momentum to the client, and produce early tangible outputs (including Company Profile, AI tools setup, and partner pre-engagements).

WEEK 1: STRATEGIC SET-UP & ENABLEMENT

Day 1 – Project Initiation

Activities

- ✓ Contract mobilisation
- ✓ Project kick-off meeting (Executive, College Management)
- ✓ Confirmation of scope, sectors, governance

Outputs

- ✓ Approved Project Charter
- ✓ Confirmed Governance Structure
- ✓ Agreed Priority Sectors

Day 2 – Strategic Alignment & Policy Mapping

Activities

- ✓ Review DHET, SETA SSPs, PGDS
- ✓ Sector prioritisation
- ✓ Triple Helix alignment mapping

Outputs

- ✓ Strategic Alignment Matrix
- ✓ Priority Sector Skills Map

Day 3 – Stakeholder & Ecosystem Mapping

Activities

- ✓ Identify national, provincial, international stakeholders
- ✓ Segment stakeholders (strategic, delivery, enablers)
- ✓ AI-assisted partner identification (databases, LinkedIn, SETAs)

Outputs

- ✓ Stakeholder Register

- ✓ AI Partner Longlist
- ✓ Engagement Strategy

Day 4 – Enabling Company Profile Development

Activities

- ✓ Develop framework-aligned Company Profile
- ✓ Define industry value proposition
- ✓ Draft sector-specific profile variants

Outputs

- ✓ Executive Company Profile (Draft)
- ✓ Sector-Specific Profile Versions
- ✓ Digital Profile Structure

Day 5 – AI & Digitisation Setup

Activities

- ✓ Configure partnership CRM
- ✓ Build AI partner scoring model
- ✓ Design dashboards & analytics

Outputs

- ✓ Digital Partnership Platform (Live)
- ✓ AI Partner Scoring Dashboard

WEEK 2: RELATIONSHIP BUILDING & PRE-AGREEMENTS

Day 6 – Industry Engagement Preparation

Activities

- ✓ Identify strategic partners for early engagement
- ✓ Prepare engagement packs
- ✓ Schedule meetings & forums

Outputs

- ✓ Priority Partner Shortlist
- ✓ Engagement Packs
- ✓ Confirmed Meeting Schedule

Day 7 – Relationship Building Sessions

Activities

- ✓ Executive roundtables
- ✓ One-on-one partner discussions
- ✓ Co-creation conversations

Outputs

- ✓ Engagement Records
- ✓ Partnership Opportunity Notes

Day 8 – Pre-Agreement Development

Activities

- ✓ Draft Letters of Intent (LoIs)
- ✓ Draft conditional MoUs
- ✓ Align commitments with framework pillars

Outputs

- ✓ Draft Pre-Agreement Templates

- ✓ Partnership Commitment Matrix

Day 9 – Validation & Governance Alignment

Activities

- ✓ Review pre-agreements internally
- ✓ Governance & compliance checks
- ✓ Risk and sustainability assessment

Outputs

- ✓ Validated Pre-Agreements
- ✓ Risk Register
- ✓ Governance Approval Notes

Day 10 – Reporting & Forward Planning

Activities

- ✓ Present inception report
- ✓ Finalise 24-month implementation roadmap
- ✓ Confirm monitoring & reporting cadence

Outputs

- ✓ Inception Report
- ✓ Approved Implementation Plan
- ✓ Monitoring & Evaluation Framework

WEEK 3: FINALISATION AND SIGN OFF

Day 11,12,13,14,15 – Review & Submission

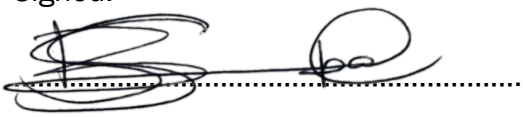
Activities

- ✓ Revision of Bidding Documents
- ✓ Compliance Sign Off
- ✓ Financial Revision

Outputs

- ✓ Bid Submission

Signed:



Sinqobile Shoba.- BID DIRECTOR.